THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** it makes the unexpected nest feel like a lucky reward	The weary team's find of a guarded nest becomes a moving moment.
2	**(b)** to show that even apparent gainers will eventually suffer	The irony shows short-term gain hiding long-term loss.
3	**(b)** so the reader can share his fears and laugh at them later	A nervous everyman creates both suspense and humour.
4	**(d)** has just lost the sun below it	The sun has gone down at the edge.
5	**(a)** aware of prejudice and wishes to be seen for his worth	He asks to be valued for his qualities.
6	**(a)** one hundredth	200 is 1/100 of 20,000.
7	**(b)** patient yet stern	He explains calmly but seriously.
8	**(b)** readers sense a harmless explanation while the narrator fears death	Readers may suspect the truth before he does.
9	**(c)** hushed and peaceful	The last lines are hushed.
10	**(c)** She keeps her father's rule though it limits her choice.	She honours the test.
11	**(b)** It helps the male win a mate in competition	Competition success is inferred.
12	**(b)** Leave some forest for the animals too.	Shares the poem's concern.
13	**(a)** it exposes his panic to everyone on deck	He looks foolish.
14	**(a)** bright colour versus grey dimness	Day fades into grey.
15	**(b)** sacrifice	Love means risking all.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	It increases the surprise and emotion of finding the nest (1) and shows their dedication to the work (1).	1+1
17	It welcomes the reservoir (1) that will eventually harm all creatures, including itself (1).	1+1
18	The phrase can mean releasing pigeons (1) or setting off a bomb, as the narrator assumes (1).	1+1
19	Gold cups, yellow sky (1) and a veil-like twilight add beauty to mildew and mould (1).	1+1
20	Each reward mocks the chooser's flaw (1): show and pride (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Mother digs up nests (1). Both parents guard hatchlings; babies ride on the male's head (1). This challenges the idea that reptiles are cold and uncaring (1).	1+1+1
22	The trout is delighted at the reservoir (1). Readers know the reservoir will destroy the valley (1). Irony shows short-sighted joy (1).	1+1+1
23	Last-minute boarding, box, grains, clicking (1). Each clue fits the narrator's fear (1). Readers are led to the same wrong conclusion (1).	1+1+1
24	Mildew is dull and unpleasant (1). Gold is bright and precious (1). The contrast shows hidden beauty (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Gold appeals to greed (1). Silver appeals to pride (1). Lead alone asks for sacrifice (1).	1+1+1
25	She shows parental care (1). She shows its decline (1). She uses specific, observed details (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The elephant says all will be homeless (1). The trout's gain is temporary (1). Harm to one part harms all (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Gharial needs fish, sand, flowing water (1). Dams, nets, floods destroyed these (1). Release failed at Satkosia (1). Habitat protection is the base of conservation (1). Benefits people too (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Gentle: animal characters, irony (1). Firm: clear statements of loss (1). Habitat destruction as central theme (1). Appeal to human conscience (1). Relevant to today (1).	2+2+1
27	Narrator lacks information (1). Imagination fills the gap (1). Every clue seems threatening (1). Facts at the end dissolve fear (1). Lesson: ask and verify (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme and setting (1). Imagery (1). Figures of speech (1). Mood and tone (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** close to disappearing	Last recorded nest signals near extinction.
2	**(a)** capable of both great good and great harm	The contradictions show a mixed nature.
3	**(d)** the men's pleased smiles when the clicking is heard	Their calm contentment contradicts the narrator's fears.
4	**(a)** cold and unpleasantly wet	Dank suggests heavy dampness.
5	**(c)** equated Portia with what many men desire	He assumed the many desire Portia.
6	**(b)** 29 per cent	2/7 is roughly 29%.
7	**(b)** It is the best poem about nature ever written.	The first is a judgment.
8	**(a)** Do not draw conclusions from partial evidence.	He misjudges by acting on guesswork.
9	**(d)** the final couplet	Hushed sedges, sleeping marshes.
10	**(b)** a pledge that must not be given away	It binds the lovers.
11	**(d)** river protection involving local people	She links gharial and river protection.
12	**(d)** The animals, who lived in the forest, were worried.	Subject-verb agreement and structure.
13	**(d)** he was truly afraid for lives	Relief matches earlier fear.
14	**(d)** It appeals more to sight than to other senses.	No story or moral is stated.
15	**(c)** The lead casket was chosen by Bassanio.	Was + past participle + by.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Their nets harm gharials (1). With their cooperation the risk can be reduced (1).	1+1
17	He has lived near humans and observed them (1). His warning is based on experience (1).	1+1
18	It stops him from warning the captain (1), forcing him to act alone and make a scene (1).	1+1
19	Compared to a spirit in a veil (1) that steals over the swale (1).	1+1
20	Loyalty to her father (1) and honesty (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Narrator's terror vs. men's calm (1). Expected bomb vs. harmless pigeons (1). Tense mood vs. humorous ending (1).	1+1+1
22	Plants, birds and lizards live there (1). It shelters the goose (1). It seems a sleeping creature (1).	1+1+1
23	She obeys the will (1). She hopes quietly (1). Her gift of ring shows her generosity (1).	1+1+1
24	A slogan such as 'Save the river, save the gharial' (1). It links animal and habitat (1). It appeals to all readers (1).	1+1+1
	OR: When the road came, the forest vanished (1). 'When' links the clauses (1). Cause-effect order retained (1).	1+1+1
25	The box really holds a danger (1). The narrator is a hero (1). The mood becomes grave instead of comic (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Cranes sail upward in flight (1). Vapours creep along the ground (1). Up and down movement closes in the scene (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Gold and silver (1). Lead (1). Bassanio's reasoning (1). Examples from life (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Introduction (1). Why sand banks matter to gharials (1). Threats and solutions (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
27	Date (1). Feelings of fear (1). Recall the bamboo and forest (1). Thoughts about humans (1). Hopes for change (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Greeting and opening (1). The narrator's example (1). Costs of panic (1). Steps: verify, ask, then act (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** Male gharials communicate with sound and display	The behaviour is signalling.
2	**(a)** their better side	It hopes humans will choose the good side.
3	**(b)** ambiguity	It can be read innocently or as an explosion.
4	**(c)** unexpected beauty in a gloomy place	Gold glints through mildew.
5	**(d)** death that ends worldly show	It warns that gold is empty.
6	**(c)** warm and admiring	She portrays gharial parents affectionately.
7	**(d)** work out the lesson themselves	A reflective ending invites thought.
8	**(b)** scenes in thrillers where a bomb is about to explode	It borrows thriller conventions for comedy.
9	**(c)** slowly and stealthily	Mist spreads slowly.
10	**(d)** a lesson on judging by worth, not show	It teaches a moral.
11	**(c)** disappointment	Few survivors show failure.
12	**(c)** Forests are destroyed by humans.	Present simple passive.
13	**(a)** it makes his fear and his duty to speak seem more urgent	Imagining many lives at stake raises the pressure.
14	**(d)** The sedges lie hushed	Inversion places the adjective first for emphasis.
15	**(b)** Morocco said that he would choose gold.	Shall becomes would; pronoun changes.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	A suitable sentence (1). Connects to nests hidden in sand to escape hyenas (1).	1+1
17	The trout was short-sighted in welcoming the reservoir (1). It could not see the long-term loss (1).	1+1
18	Contrast of terror and a harmless pigeon race (1). The men think him mad (1).	1+1
19	First: yellow light (1). Last: grey vapour and sleep (1).	1+1
20	He has met prejudice (1) and wants to be valued for worth (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Morocco: appearances deceive (1). Arragon: pride is foolish (1). Bassanio: love requires giving (1).	1+1+1
22	It protects eggs and young from early dangers (1). It adds numbers (1). Without safe rivers, released animals die, as at Satkosia (1).	1+1+1
23	Animals speak and reason (1). We see human actions from outside (1). The message feels simple and strong (1).	1+1+1
24	Suspense builds as ten o'clock nears (1). Surprise comes when pigeons emerge (1). Both together create the twist (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Cranes 'sail up' it (1). Silence becomes sky or sea (1). The image deepens the stillness (1).	1+1+1
25	Morocco: brave, polite, misled by show (1). Arragon: haughty, proud (1). Both fail in judgement (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Work happens in India, Bangladesh and Nepal (1). Rivers cross borders (1). Shared effort is needed to save a species across its range (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Setting (1). Colours (1). Simile or metaphor (1). Personification (1). Ending image (1).	2+2+1

	OR: State view (1). Her loss of choice (1). Her acceptance (1). The fairness to suitors (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
27	Purpose: inform and persuade (1). Specific facts and numbers (1). Warm descriptions of parenting (1). Examples of failure (1). Appeal for rivers (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Characters and personification (1). Irony and tone (1). Language and structure (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

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